CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

MEAL-PREP BUSINESS OWNER IN THE AI ERA

Busy people outsourced dinner to a weekly box. Somebody still has to make that box taste like a human cooked it.

★ TL;DR — The deal: weekly meals cooked in batches for subscribers, around ~$75K median, launchable in 1–6 months from pilot to subscriptions. The catch: it's a logistics business wearing an apron — production days are marathons. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

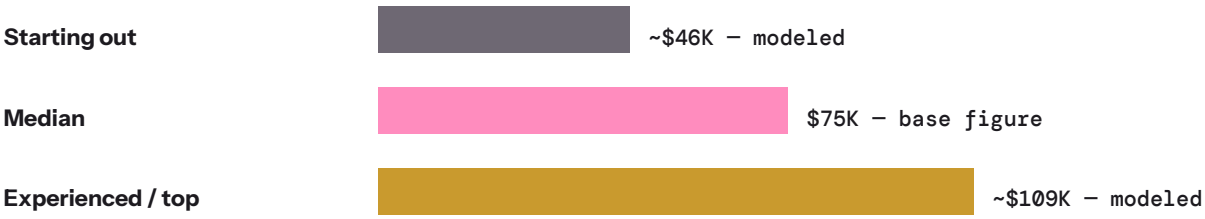
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Convenience is the product; taste on day four is the retention.
- Software takes orders; the cooking is one glorious weekly production day.
- Subscriptions turn cooking skill into predictable recurring revenue.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Meal-Prep Business Owner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A MEAL-PREP BUSINESS OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Design weekly menus that survive reheating gracefully
- ✓ Cook in batches: shop, prep, portion, label, pack

✓ Run subscriptions, deliveries and the weekly order cycle

✓ Track food costs, waste and which meals get reordered

Think: a restaurant where every customer eats at home, all week, from your Sunday.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Menu-planning software, portioning lines and delivery logistics automate chunks of this. Small-batch trust and taste stay local and human.	Tasting and balancing food meant to be reheated days later, and building menus a stranger's whole week can ride on.

⚠ **Food rules for selling prepared meals are strict and local. Get the kitchen and labeling right before the subscriber list, not after the first complaint.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ One or two production days, not six services a week ✓ Recurring subscribers: revenue you can forecast ✓ Cook at volume in a real kitchen rhythm you design	✗ Sunday is production day — weekends bend around it ✗ Churn quietly eats growth if food slips ✗ Packaging and delivery costs bite every single box

Good fit? You're systematic, a solid volume cook, and you get a kick out of a production day that runs like clockwork.

Bad fit? You cook inspired one-offs but die of boredom repeating a menu at volume.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — NEIGHBORHOOD SUBSCRIPTION START	DOOR B — GYM / OFFICE PARTNERSHIPS
Start hyper-local: one neighborhood, one pickup point, 15–30 loyal subscribers. Tiny batches keep quality high and rent at zero until volume proves out.	Partner with gyms, offices or clinics as their in-house meal plan. Their audience becomes your distribution from week one.

Smart move: Design for day-four taste, not day-one photos. Meals that reheat beautifully are why subscribers stay — churn is the whole game.

Where you land after: A production kitchen with corporate contracts, or a regional meal-prep brand.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
PROVE THE	RUN A	GET PRODUCTION	SYSTEMATIZE THE	LAUNCH SUBSCRIPTIO	GROW THE

STEP 1 — Prove the food survives

PRODUCT TEST · WEEKS

- Cook one full week of meals and eat them yourself on schedule
- No license is required to plan and test, but map your local rules for selling prepared food before taking money

STEP 2 — Run a paid pilot

PILOT CUSTOMERS · 1-6 MONTHS

- Sell pilot weeks to 5–10 people at honest prices
- Survey every meal — keep only what gets reordered

STEP 3 — Get production legal

THE FRAME

- Arrange licensed commercial kitchen time or your compliant production space
- Packaging, labels and allergen discipline set up properly

STEP 4 — Systematize the cook

PRODUCTION DAY

- One or two big cook days, portioned and packed to system
- Delivery routes and pickup windows fixed and communicated

STEP 5 — Launch subscriptions

SUBSCRIPTIONS

- Convert pilots into weekly subscriptions with pause-anytime terms
- Anchor pricing to your true per-meal cost and time

STEP 6 — Grow the roster

YEAR ONE

- Add a second menu track (family, fitness) only when operations are smooth
- Corporate lunch contracts stabilize the week

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: cook and pack 10 test meals; photograph them on day one and day four honestly.
- □ Days 1–30: 5 paying test customers eating weekly; feedback forms ruthless and short.
- □ Days 31–60: licensed kitchen hours booked; production day runs a full cycle.

 Days 61–90: subscriptions offered to the test group; churn and waste counted weekly.

 Day 90: a small recurring roster pays for the kitchen — growth is now a math problem.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ SUNDAY COOKS THE WEEK. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.